MONTHLY UPDATE

Libya: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The Attorney General's Office ordered two National Oil Corporation officials into pre-trial detention over leaked oil-sector data. The central bank reported about 1.75 million of 2.2 million public employees registered on its real-time payroll system. A decree of 14 September made registration on the unified digital trade system compulsory for importers and exporters, and work began on an integrated national cybersecurity plan on 20 September.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

Trade was tied to the banking system and to a register. Importing goods for trade outside banking channels is prohibited from 30 September 2026 under decision 449 of 2026, which ties import operations to banking and customs procedures and to registration on the unified digital trade system, and the capital's chamber of commerce has met on whether the date can be met and what the decision will cost its members.

Regional collaboration

UNDP, a Gulf telecoms group and a Doha institute convened a digital and AI policy leaders forum for the Arab states region in Doha, reported on 2 September, to move a regional digital policy framework to country-level action.

Standards

The committee behind the national information system spent its sixth meeting fixing its own composition. Meeting in Tripoli on 1 September it reviewed financial indicators and settled its membership rules, tying permanent seats to the office of director of an information and documentation centre and requiring a written letter for a proxy. Its mandate, its published output and the indicators it reviewed are not held — what is established is that it meets, and now who sits on it.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

The central bank's statement for January to August 2026 puts spending on the communications authority and its affiliates at LYD 25.2m, all of it salaries and operating costs and nothing in the development chapter, against state outlay of LYD 68.8bn. The August salaries are not yet in it, and the unified 2026 budget it executes against is not in the repository, so no digital appropriation for the year can be read. The central bank's statement for January to September 2026 puts the communications authority and its affiliates at LYD 31.7m of state outlay of LYD 88.6bn.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The telecommunications authority held a first workshop with the ITU and the national crisis management centre to review the national emergency telecommunications plan, reported on 28 September; the plan was conceived after communications with Derna failed during Storm Daniel in 2023. Negotiations between a satellite internet operator and the regulator, open since 2024, have reached no agreement. One operator's published tariff card runs from 0.5 LYD for 50MB over one day to 80 LYD for 80GB over thirty days. A state holding-company subsidiary reviewed its project for 7,000 telecommunications towers at its general assembly; no count of towers built, cost or completion date is published.

Data Storage

A first independent assessment of a Libyan facility reached the record: a tier III design certification for the national telecom company's KM-4 site, with no capacity figures disclosed.

Energy

The renewable energy authority's off-grid programme covers 400 solar systems at 310 kW peak for remote clusters and border posts.

Technical Capacity

A private certification is on record: tier III design status for the national telecom company's KM-4 site. Certification by a foreign body is standing in for a domestic licence that does not yet exist. Inside government, the technical and vocational education ministry said its own information systems section had rebuilt its electronic archiving system, with operator training due from 28 September.

Cybersecurity

Work opened on 20 September on an integrated national cybersecurity plan, bringing together the heads of the cybersecurity and digital sovereignty authority, the information authority and the information security authority. No draft or timetable is published.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The forgery count grew: 3,090 national numbers issued on forged civil-status data at the Majdul registry office were halted and suspects referred for investigation. The public prosecutor announced a further case of civil-status data falsified for payment, with work at a registry office halted and suspects referred for investigation, against more than 89,000 forged national numbers in the last official count.

Digital Payments and Fintech

At a Tripoli conference on 7 September the central bank governor announced a link to the Arab regional payments platform, a study track on a central bank digital currency and stablecoins, a cyber-skills programme, and a pilot for accession to China's cross-border interbank system targeted at early 2027. None carries an instrument, budget, participant list or delivery date, and the transfer-value figure the same account reports is not taken into the repository.

The central bank rewrote the wallet rules. Circular 9/2026 replaces the 2017 instructions for licensed electronic-payment companies, setting daily limits for Libyans of LYD 100,000 person to person, 500,000 person to business and 2 million business to business, lower limits for foreigners, and opening wallets to lawful residents on a passport or residence document and a phone number in their name. No count of wallets in use is published.

September public-sector salaries were paid through the Ratibak Lahzi system with about 1.75 million of 2.2 million public employees registered, 79%, against 76% in July; the central bank is automating complaint handling for undisbursed salaries with the finance ministry. The central bank put electronic transactions at about LD 865 billion by the end of September 2026. A private bank is to launch payments to China through a Chinese payment platform from its own application, capped at US$5,000 a transaction and US$50,000 a year. The banking sector development forum stopped pursuing its Zero Cash initiative on 7 September for want of an executive framework from the central bank.

Registries

The economy ministry made registration on the unified digital trade system compulsory for importers, exporters and foreign suppliers under decree 465 of 14 September 2026; a transitional period runs to the end of 2026. Pilot electronic issuance of the Unified Economic Number began on 9 September, free of charge through the national digital government services platform.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A complaints route was put behind the visa system. The citizen service centre and the passports authority agreed a joint mechanism to receive and handle citizens' and residents' enquiries and complaints on the electronic visa, and to unify the communication channels between the agencies involved. No caseload, response standard or list of the channels being unified is published, so the mechanism is established and its capacity is not.

Customs met international contractors on 15 September to revive automated inspection and coastal monitoring contracts concluded earlier and never completed; no value, date or company list is published. The central bank governor proposed an electronic system and single database to record and track international grants, programmes and projects to the committee formed for the purpose; it is under discussion.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

A Tripoli municipality began electronic archiving of staff data, records and documents in its human resources department on 11 September, the latest of several single-council records projects; no national standard or shared system for municipal records is on file.

Rural digital data capture

The renewable energy authority's off-grid programme is now on the record at 400 solar systems, 310 kW peak, for remote clusters and border posts.

Capacity

Training and skills

The social affairs ministry and the minister of state for digital economy and artificial intelligence signed a memorandum launching the Wasl initiative at the Libya AI Forum in Tripoli on 10 October 2026, with one track on digital and artificial-intelligence skills for social-affairs staff and another on the digital empowerment of persons with disabilities.

Inclusion

Access to services

A foreign cultural body signed a memorandum giving Benghazi university's students access to its digital library of over 80,000 resources, announced on 9 September; the university lost much of its physical collection during the war. The administrative oversight authority's Raqib platform takes complaints against about 750 state bodies.

Data

National statistics

The information authority met the information centres of the prime minister's office and several ministries in Tripoli on 14 September to agree how they supply indicators to a Unified Directory for National Indicators, and set the order for completing it. The directory is not yet published. A green industry centre published a report of industrial and environmental indicators recording 305 registered industrial establishments, 301 of them private, and 26,034 workers.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The communications authority and the United States State Department signed a strategic cooperation framework covering digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence, data centres, cybersecurity and satellite communications.

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